



**The
journey
begins
as
Cubs!**



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy

Executive Summary



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy is one of the largest, best equipped cricket academies in the Gulf region and established as one of the pre-eminent academies in UAE training over 4000 registered students in Cricket over the years.

Academy Overview

- Established in October 2007.
- Wholly owned by founder promoters.
- Registered cricket academy in UAE and affiliated member of Emirates Cricket Board, Dubai Sports Council, Dubai Cricket Council, Sharjah Cricket Council & Ajman Cricket Council.
- One of the leading cricket academies in the Middle East.
- More than 30 qualified and experienced coaches.
- Qualified physical trainer, Events and Tour Manager and a team of Administration staff.
- Well structured curriculum with the use of latest equipment and technology i.e. bowling machines and video analysis.
- Integrated Academy Management System and Accounting module.
- Core business model is scalable and profitable, with multiple lines of income.
- Steady Revenue growth YoY.
- 2024/2025 Revenue was USD 1.63M.



Executive Summary



Key Milestones

2007 - 2011

- Oct 2007 commenced cricket coaching with a group of 11 youngsters.
- In the year 2011 moved to Sharjah English School, which is still the main coaching centre.

2012

- Commenced cricket coaching at Dubai College, Jumeirah and Deira International School, Al Badia, Dubai Festival City.

2013

- Toured England & Wales and had the largest group size of 165 including players and their families to become the largest cricket tour ever undertaken by an academy with seven teams including a Ladies team.

2014

- Toured Cape Town with two teams to become the first cricket academy in UAE to embark on a cricket tour to South Africa.

2015

- Constructed four international standard natural grass turf center pitches at Sharjah English School to become the first school to have turf pitches in UAE.

2016

- Toured Brisbane with 5 teams to become the first cricket academy in UAE to embark on a cricket tour to Australia.

- Commenced cricket coaching at Jumeira Baccalaureate School and GEMS New Millennium School, Al Khail, Dubai.

2018

- Commenced cricket coaching at Tennis & Country Club Fujairah. Being the first academy to conduct cricket coaching in the emirate of Fujairah.

2019

- Commenced cricket coaching at Delhi Private School, The Gardens, Jebel Ali, Dubai.
- Toured Harare with 4 teams to become the first cricket academy in UAE to embark on a cricket tour to Zimbabwe.
- Opened the first overseas branch for cricket in Melbourne, Australia.
- Commenced cricket coaching at MSB Private School (DPS), Al Nahda 2, Dubai.

2020

- Commenced cricket coaching at Uptown International School, Mirdif, Dubai.

2021

- Commenced cricket coaching at The English College, Al Safa, Dubai.

Executive Summary



Key Milestones

2022

- Signed the first Sports facility management agreement with Star International School (SIS), Al Qusais, Dubai and commenced cricket coaching at the centre.
- Toured Pretoria, Johannesburg & Rustenburg with 5 teams to become the first cricket academy in UAE to embark on a cricket tour to these cities in South Africa.
- Conducted the ICCA Champions Trophy tournament in Colombo, Sri Lanka with cricket teams participating from UAE, India, Zimbabwe & Sri Lanka.

2023

- Founded the International Council for Cricket Academies (ICCA) to create a council which would govern and facilitate in the development and growth of young aspiring international cricketers through the hosting and organizing of international tournaments, tours and Masterclass programs.
- Toured England with the largest group size of 220 including players and their families to become the largest cricket tour ever undertaken by an academy with 10 teams including a Parents team.
- Conducted the first ICCA Global Academy Championship tournament in Nottinghamshire, UK with cricket teams participating from USA, UK, UAE, India, Sri Lanka & Zimbabwe. All together 550+ participants attended this global mega event.

2024

- Conducted the first GCCA T20 Championship tournament in Sharjah, UAE.
- Toured Brisbane with 9 teams to participate in the ICCA Global Academy Championship tournament and cricket tour in collaboration with Queensland Cricket Australia to play 50 Overs longer version games with participants from UAE, Australia, USA, Sri Lanka & Qatar.
- Commenced cricket coaching at Dira International School, Al Badia, Festival City, Dubai.

2025

- Toured Sri Lanka with a group of 150 delegates including players and their families to participate 40/50 Overs longer version games and the GCCA International Academy T20 Championship, organized in collaboration with the Mercantile Cricket Association (MCA), Colombo.
- Commenced indoor cricket coaching at Baseline Sports Academy, Dubai Investment Park (DIP), Dubai.
- Commenced cricket coaching at Apple International Community School, Al Karama, Dubai.

Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Executive Team



Kunal Seth

Chairman, Desert Cubs Cricket Academy UAE &
Global Council for Cricket Academies (GCCA)



Presley Polonnowita

Founder & CEO, Desert Cubs Cricket Academy UAE &
President of Global Council for Cricket Academies (GCCA)



Anoj Silva

Director, Desert Cubs Cricket Academy UAE,
Head of Finance & Executive Committee Member GCCA



Farah Polonnowita

Head of HR & Administration

Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Introduction

Desert Cubs Cricket Academy is proud to be a far-sighted academy that nurtures young generation of cricketers into professionally successful sportsmen and sportswomen of the future.

Young players at Desert Cubs are trained to be stronger, to think and act as leaders and to equip themselves with self-confidence in the face of adversity on and off the field.

We aim to transform our Cubs into **'LEGENDS OF THE FUTURE'** and their journey begins, right here with us at Desert Cubs.



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Our Vision

“To be the best Cricket Academy in UAE admired for its effectiveness, methods, quality and performance.”

Desert Cubs envisions acting as an academy to effectively nurture and develop young and talented athletes for the future.

Our long-term goal is to set up a Sporting Centre of Excellence with training and coaching facilities for all major sports in the Gulf to produce **‘LEGENDS OF THE FUTURE’**, who can adapt to the current and future challenges in the domestic and international sports arena.

Our Mission

“To produce quality sportsmen and sportswomen who can respond well to the current and future challenges of Domestic and International Circuit.”

We are dedicated to uplift the standard of sports in the UAE by producing well-talented athletes with all-round personalities.

We focus on embedding basic skills in young athletes who are right at the starting point of their careers to help them become competitive individuals and legends in their respective sports. Our coaching curriculums are designed to gradually instil all the necessary skills and competencies in young athletes so that they are fully equipped for challenges of different forms of the games. Our qualified coaches are dedicated to explore and deliver new dimensions of coaching which is one of our main strengths.

Desert Cubs Crickey Academy – The Journey



The Pride



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy, the largest cricket academy in the Gulf region was born with a passion by Presley Polonnowita, Founder and Head Coach of the academy, to nurture young talents to become great sportsmen & sportswomen and Legends of the future.

It was a modest establishment for us, at the beginning, at a corner net of Sharjah International Cricket Stadium's practice facilities with a group of 11 youngsters.

Since then, our growth has been rapid and unstoppable, and today we are the largest, best equipped, registered cricket academy in the UAE. We are proud to establish ourselves as one of the pre-eminent academies in UAE for training over 3000 registered members in Cricket.



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

Our training centres provide state of the art facilities with top class coaching techniques which are renowned for their quality and finesses. We are the largest, best equipped and registered cricket academies in the Gulf region.

Desert Cubs currently conducts cricket coaching sessions in Sharjah and Dubai.

Sharjah English School (SES) – Maliha Road, Sharjah

- Natural grass ground.
- Six natural grass turf center pitches with floodlights.
- Digital scoreboard.
- Live streaming of matches.
- Pavilion for viewing.
- Seven side practice nets with natural grass turf and Astro turf pitches with flood lights.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.
- High speed and slow-motion video cameras for analysis.
- Auditorium facilities for psychological sessions and video analysis.
- Gymnasium for cardio, fitness and strengthening sessions with instructors.

Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

Sharjah English School (SES)



Desert Cubs Sports Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

Delhi Private School (DPS) – The Gardens, Jebel Ali, Dubai

- Astro turf ground with Astro center pitch and floodlights.
- Three side practice nets with Astro turf pitches and floodlights.
- Pavilion for viewing.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.



Desert Cubs Sports Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

Deira International School (DIS) – Al Badia, Dubai Festival City

- Natural grass ground.
- Astro turf center pitch.
- Four side practice nets with natural grass turf and Astro turf pitches and floodlights.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

Star International School (SIS) – Al Qusais 3, Dubai

- Astro turf ground with floodlights.
- Six side practice nets with natural grass turf and Astro turf pitches with flood lights.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Facility Management

Star International School (SIS), Al Qusais 3, Dubai



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – The Journey



Training Centres

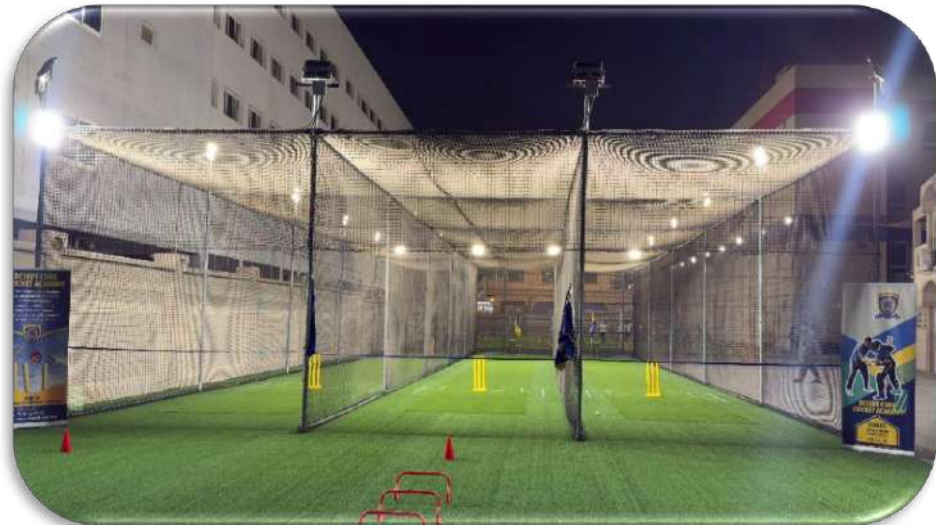
Baseline Sports Academy (BSA) – Dubai Investment Park (DIP)

- State of the art modern indoor facility and one of a kind in the UAE.
- Equipped with five cricket lanes.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.
- High speed and slow-motion video cameras for analysis.



Apple International Community School (AIS) – Al Karama, Dubai

- Three side practice nets with Astro turf pitches with flood lights.
- Astro turf ground area for fielding and fitness.
- Bowling machine.
- Equipment for fielding drills.



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Coaches & Staff



Strength of the Academy



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Differentiation



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Achievements



Winner of the first
ECB Women's League 2017



League Champion & Runner up of the
ECB Under 17 National Academy
League 2017-2018



Winner of the ECB Under 14
National Academy League 2018-2019



Winner of the ECB Under 19
National Academy League 2019-2020



Winner of the ECB Under 16
National Academy League 2020-2021



Winner of the ECB Under 16
National Academy League 2024-2025

Desert Cubs Awards for Season 2017-2018



Ace Indian Cricketer Ravichandran Ashwin honours the Desert Cubs Annual Cricket Awards Ceremony held at Hotel InterContinental, Dubai on 09th November 2018



Desert Cubs Awards for Season 2018-2019



Former South African Cricketer Jonty Rhodes honours the Desert Cubs Annual Cricket Awards Ceremony held at Hotel Crown Plaza, Dubai on 29th November 2019



High Performance Programs conducted at Desert Cubs



Pace Foundation conducted by former Sri Lanka National fast bowling legend & former ACC Senior Development Officer **Rumesh Ratnayake** from 19th to 22nd October 2016



Masterclass Program conducted by former World Cup winning coach, **Dav Whatmore** from 09th to 11th November 2017



High Performance Program conducted by former World Cup winning Sri Lanka opener **Romesh Kaluwitharana** from 26th to 28th March 2018



Masterclass Program conducted by ace Indian cricketer **Ravichandran Ashwin** from 08th to 10th November 2018 at Desert Cubs. SES and DIS centres



High Performance Programs conducted at Desert Cubs



Masterclass Program conducted by former South African cricketer **Jonty Rhodes** from 28th to 30th November 2019 at Desert Cubs' SES and DPS centres



Masterclass Program conducted by ace Indian cricketer **Dinesh Karthik** on 19th October 2021 at Desert Cubs' DPS centre



High Performance Programs conducted at Desert Cubs



Masterclass Program conducted by former Sri Lankan cricketer **Chaminda Vaas** from 01st to 03rd April 2022 at Desert Cubs' SES and DPS centres



Masterclass Program conducted by former Sri Lanka master batsman and former test & one-day captain, **Marvan Atapattu** from 14th to 16th October 2022 at Desert Cubs' SES and ECD centres



Cricketing Personalities at Desert Cubs



Graeme Smith



Kevin Peterson



Aaqib Javed



Aravinda De Silva



Upul Chandana



Abdul Razzaq



Imran Nazir



Dilshan Munaweera

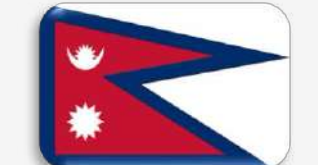


Malinda Pushpakumara

Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Overseas Cricket Tours

Desert Cubs Sports Academy has organized several overseas cricket tours during its journey, namely to England & Wales, Australia, South Africa, India, Sri Lanka, Malaysia, Oman, Qatar, Zimbabwe & Nepal. Desert Cubs is known for organizing well executed cricket tours combined with quality accommodation and sight-seeing tours for the whole family.

- 2008 - Malaysia & Sri Lanka
- 2009 - Sri Lanka
- 2010 - United Kingdom & Oman
- 2011 - United Kingdom
- 2012 - Sri Lanka, Malaysia & India (Bangalore)
- 2013 - United Kingdom & Qatar (Doha)
- 2014 - South Africa (Cape Town), United Kingdom, Sri Lanka & India (New Delhi)
- 2015 - Australia (Brisbane)
- 2016 - Sri Lanka & India (Bangalore)
- 2017 - United Kingdom, India (Chennai) & Sri Lanka
- 2018 - Australia (Gold Coast), India (Mumbai) & Malaysia
- 2019 - Zimbabwe (Harare), India (Chennai) & Nepal
- 2022 - South Africa (Pretoria, Johannesburg & Rustenburg)
- 2023 - United Kingdom & Sri Lanka
- 2024 - Australia (Brisbane)
- 2025 - Sri Lanka



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Overseas Cricket Tours



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy – Overseas Cricket Tours



Desert Cubs Cricket Academy Tour of United Kingdom from 14th to 26th July 2023
with the largest group size of 220 including players and their families to become the
largest cricket tour ever undertaken by an academy with ten teams including a Parents team



Corporate Social Responsibility



Desert Cubs Charity Drive

Desert Cubs donate funds every year to the Sputnik Girls' Home in Kanumale, Sri Lanka from the generous contributions received from their members, coaches, well-wishers and direct funds from the academy through its charity drive.

In addition, cricket gear was donated to schools and a few less fortunate talented cricketers in July 2025



Cricket gear donation to
St. Ann's College, Kurunegala, SL



Cricket gear donation to
Weerasekara National School -
Hal Sarigama, Katukithula SL



Corporate Social Responsibility



Desert Cubs Charity Drive

Desert Cubs along with its members and the massive support of the Rachel Foundation – UAE distribute 500Kg of books to two orphanages and to one school in Sri Lanka in July 2025, bringing knowledge, hope, and joy to many children.





DESERT CUBS CRICKET ACADEMY UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

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